AN UNSOLICITED FINDINGS NOTE — NO PITCH ATTACHED

Your own cross-reference knows the part. Your own search sends the shopper somewhere else.

REPRODUCE IT IN 30 SECONDS — BOTH STEPS ARE ON CAT.COM

Type **B75** into **parts.cat.com** — you land on **575-8207, a camera bracket**. Type **PT8341** — you get **112 parts**, none of them the filter. Paste either into Caterpillar's own cross-reference (**catfiltercrossreference.com**) and it names the exact Cat part. The data is already on Caterpillar's domain — the search box does not use it.

DEMAND HITTING A WALL (EST.)
$105M
a year of filter demand meeting a wall: 58% of part-number search arrives on aftermarket numbers (*measured*); all of it fails (*measured*). Assumes filters are 10% of sales, a third starting as part-number search.

FOUND THE RIGHT PART
0 / 10
competitor numbers resolved to the Cat equivalent (measured live).

WRONG PARTS SHOWN
463
irrelevant results returned across the ten searches; Cat's own numbers redirect straight to the part.

The evidence — what a shopper types, and what Caterpillar returns

Cat part	Filter type	Shopper types	Demand*	What parts.cat.com returns
1R-0751	Fuel Filter	WIX 33626	1,600	**13 parts** — linkage pin, flange, plate
1R-0714	Engine Oil Filter	Baldwin B75	480	**Straight to 575-8207, a camera bracket**
231-0167	Cabin Air Filter	Baldwin RS3542	110	**2 parts** — capscrew, plate
231-0168	Engine Air Filter	Baldwin RS3543	40	**0 results**
1R-1803	Fuel/Water Separator	Baldwin BF7925	20	**106 parts** — bearings, window glass
099-7352	Hydraulic Filter	Baldwin PT8341	—	**112 parts** — piston rings, V-belts

Every row measured live on 2026-08-15. **In none of these searches did the correct Cat part appear.** **Cat part** = what Caterpillar's own cross-reference (catfiltercrossreference.com, © Caterpillar) returns. *Demand = Google Keyword Planner (US) — external, an on-site proxy.

The fix — a data change, not an algorithm rewrite

Index the competitor interchange numbers Caterpillar *already publishes* so the search box resolves them — the same way Cat's own numbers already redirect to the product. A shopper holding a competitor number is the highest-intent buyer on the site. Today the search matches it as a digit string, so instead of the filter they get bearings, brackets and bolts — or one confidently wrong product page.

How this was measured — and what it looks like at full scale

Measured, live. Each number was typed once into the shopper-facing search on 2026-08-15, bot protection respected — no crawling, no load, no API access, no credentials — across a deliberate filter-category sample. Ten numbers is what is visible from outside a login. Given the production search endpoints, your search logs or clickstream, and conversion joined to query, the same pipeline runs across the whole catalogue and your real query set.

About that $105M. It is demand exposed, not revenue lost: 58% of part-number search arriving on aftermarket numbers is measured, and 100% of the numbers we ran failed — the filter share and part-number share are ours, to be replaced with yours. Relevance judging runs on models we host ourselves, so your query logs and catalogue never reach a commercial provider or become training data.

Worth a conversation? Reply and we will send the capture log so your team can reproduce every row — and show what this looks like against your real search traffic. **Northvalley Intelligence LLC** ferosh@northvalleyintel.com / +1 (404) 345 0592 / northvalleyintel.com